



two more teams are set to join (the Hyderabad Toofans and BC Jindal Group Mumbai).

"The thrill right now is ample, but only maybe when two more teams join, we will get the wholehearted feel of HIL-W being a tournament. It will get interesting because many of us will end up in different teams, and the competitiveness of the entire group will kick in," says Tete.

Apart from rubbing shoulders with world-class players, the Indians will also get the opportunity to learn new ideas and tactics from coaching staff coming in from around the world. **Ten of the total 12 teams have head coaches who are from overseas.**

"I think this is a boosting period for young players to learn lessons about themselves... 'Where am I as a player? What are the next steps that I need to take?'"

And now, in that mix, you throw in international coaches,



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who have maybe a different view of things; so whether it's better or not, sometimes a different view helps you learn about new elements and new tactics," says Pasha Gademan, who will coach the Toofans (men).

UP Rudras technical director Cedric D'Souza, who previously coached the Indian national team and the now-defunct Delhi Waveriders, has a wish.

"I hope to see the men's team win the Olympics gold in 2028 and the women's team in 2032." Much like Cedric, several Indian men's and women's players of the current and upcoming generation harbour similar ambitions. The revival of the HIL seems to be a step in the right direction.